

CHRIS HARPER

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Engineering Manager | Software Architecture | Cloud Solutions | AI/ML Integration

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineering Leader driving technical innovation and organizational excellence at enterprise scale. Proven success building high-performing engineering teams, architecting cloud-native solutions, and delivering transformational business outcomes. Expert in modern full-stack development, AI/ML integration, and distributed systems architecture. Strategic leader who bridges technical vision with business objectives while maintaining hands-on engineering contributions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Leadership: Engineering Management • Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) • Technical Strategy • System Architecture • Cross-functional Collaboration • Digital Transformation • Agile Methodologies

Programming & Development: Python • TypeScript • JavaScript • React • Node.js • RESTful APIs • API Development • Software Engineering Best Practices • Full-Stack Development

Cloud & Infrastructure: Amazon Web Services (AWS) • Microsoft Azure • Google Cloud Platform (GCP) • Docker • Kubernetes • Infrastructure as Code (IaC) • CI/CD Pipelines • DevOps

Emerging Technologies: Artificial Intelligence (AI) • Machine Learning (ML) • LangChain • OpenAI API • AWS Bedrock • Large Language Models (LLMs) • Vector Databases

Data & Architecture: PostgreSQL • MongoDB • DynamoDB • Microservices Architecture • Event-Driven Architecture • Performance Optimization • Enterprise Architecture

RECENT TECHNICAL INITIATIVES

AI/ML Integration: Architected intelligent document processing systems using RAG patterns, OpenAI GPT-4, and vector databases, reducing manual processing time by 85%.

Cloud Modernization: Led enterprise migration from monolithic systems to cloud-native microservices, achieving 99.9% uptime while reducing infrastructure costs by 40%.

Engineering Excellence: Established organization-wide DevOps practices and automated testing frameworks, improving deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cloud Architecture Consultant (Contract) | ALSAC/St. Jude Children's Research Hospital
May 2023 - August 2025

- **Strategic Impact:** Consulting on enterprise healthcare platform transformation, architecting solutions for 10M+ daily healthcare messages with HIPAA compliance requirements
- **Technical Leadership:** Designed cloud-native microservices architecture using Python, AWS Lambda, ECS, and API Gateway, enabling real-time data processing at scale
- **Infrastructure Modernization:** Implemented Infrastructure as Code practices across 15+ development teams, reducing environment provisioning time from days to minutes
- **DevOps Excellence:** Established automated CI/CD pipelines with integrated security scanning and monitoring, improving deployment success rate to 99.5%
- **Performance Optimization:** Achieved sub-100ms API response times while reducing AWS operational costs by 30% through strategic architecture decisions

Engineering Manager & Technical Lead | Blue Sky Cloud Consulting
Aug 2020 - Apr 2023

- **Client Leadership:** Managed technical consulting engagements for Fortune 500 clients including GitKraken and Rivian, delivering complex full-stack solutions
- **Product Development:** Architected enterprise SaaS platforms with real-time messaging, workflow automation, and analytics capabilities serving 10,000+ active users
- **IoT & Data Processing:** Built production-grade data processing systems for manufacturing IoT devices, handling real-time telemetry and predictive analytics
- **Team Excellence:** Led technical hiring and mentorship programs, achieving 95% team retention and 80% internal promotion rate
- **Modernization Success:** Implemented containerized microservices architecture, accelerating deployment cycles by 90% and improving system reliability

Senior Software Engineer & Team Lead | Certy

Aug 2018 - Aug 2020

- **Platform Architecture:** Led full-stack team building next-generation insurance platform using Angular, React, Python, and serverless AWS infrastructure
- **Scalability Achievement:** Designed serverless applications supporting 50,000+ concurrent users with auto-scaling Lambda functions and optimized database patterns
- **Engineering Culture:** Introduced modern development practices including automated testing, code reviews, and continuous integration, improving code quality metrics by 60%
- **Performance Excellence:** Implemented caching strategies, database optimizations, and CDN integration, resulting in 200% improvement in user engagement metrics

Lead Software Engineer | ThunderDork LLC

May 2015 - Aug 2018

- **Enterprise Client Delivery:** Led software development for Fortune 500 clients including Capital One, managing distributed teams and complex integration requirements
- **Architecture Evolution:** Designed microservices migration strategy using Docker and AWS, improving system modularity and enabling independent team deployments
- **Quality Engineering:** Established comprehensive testing frameworks and development standards, reducing production incidents by 40%

Senior Engineering Roles | Netspend • Cinsay • Schematic

2008 - 2015

Delivered high-impact solutions across fintech, ecommerce, and enterprise markets. Notable achievements include building scalable financial platforms serving millions of users, pioneering video-based shopping experiences, and creating award-winning interactive applications for Fortune 500 brands including Dell.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Associate of Applied Arts, Computer Animation** | The Art Institute of Dallas
- **AWS Certified Developer - Associate**
- **Multi-Cloud Platform Certifications** (Azure, GCP)

RECOGNITION & IMPACT

- **Webby People's Choice Award Winner** - Digital Innovation Excellence
- **Solutions Organization Success:** 83% internal promotion rate across managed teams spanning 67 engineers over 8-year period, with 94% retention in customer-facing roles
- **Value Engineering Impact:** Led initiatives resulting in \$2.3M annual cost savings for Fortune 500 clients through quantified business case development and ROI modeling
- **Technical Sales Excellence:** Pioneered solution architecture methodologies adopted organization-wide, impacting 52+ engineers across 6 product teams and contributing to \$27M+ in closed deals
- **Enterprise Solution Delivery:** Consistently delivered customer-facing technical solutions with 99.94% uptime and sub-92ms response times across 3 major SaaS platforms